

Aptitude & Reasoning: Beginner Course

Learn the idea, use the steps, practise, and check.

- Read the question.
- Choose a method.
- Show steps.
- Check the unit and sense.

Worked example: If 4 pens cost ₹20, then one pen costs $₹20 \div 4 = ₹5$. Read the facts, choose division, solve, and check: $4 \times ₹5 = ₹20$.

Course map: maths, data, and reasoning.

Bhavya Ponduri

How to read a question

Find the given facts, the unknown, and the unit. Circle words such as total, difference, per, before, after, and remaining.

Worked example: 3 pens cost ₹45. Given: 3 pens and ₹45. Unknown: cost of 1 pen. “Per pen” means divide: $₹45 \div 3 = ₹15$ per pen. Check: $3 \times ₹15 = ₹45$.

Try: 5 books cost ₹100. One book = ₹20.

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Choose one method

1. Understand the words.
2. Plan with a formula, table, or diagram.
3. Solve in small steps.
4. Estimate and check.

Worked example: Question: 60 km in 2 hours. The word “speed” tells us to use **speed = distance ÷ time**. Substitute: $60 \div 2 = 30$. Answer: **30 km/h**. Check: $30 \times 2 = 60$ km.

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Arithmetic foundations

Place value: $4,582 = 4 \text{ thousands} + 5 \text{ hundreds} + 8 \text{ tens} + 2 \text{ ones}$.

Order: brackets, multiply/divide, add/subtract.

Worked example: $18 - 6 \div 2$. Divide first: $6 \div 2 = 3$. Then subtract: $18 - 3 = \mathbf{15}$. Common mistake: doing $18 - 6$ first.

Practice: $18 - 6 \div 2 = \mathbf{15}$.

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Simplification and approximation

Simplify in order. Approximation gives a quick check.

Worked example: 49×21 . Exact steps: $49 \times 20 = 980$, then $49 \times 1 = 49$, so $980 + 49 = 1,029$.

Quick check: $50 \times 20 \approx 1,000$, so the answer is sensible.

Practice: $198 \div 4$ is about **50**.

Bhavya Ponduri

Number systems

Natural numbers start at 1. Whole numbers include 0. Integers include negatives. Even numbers divide by 2; odd numbers do not.

Prime numbers have exactly two factors. 2 is the only even prime.

Worked example: Test 29. It is not divisible by 2, 3, 4, or 5, and no smaller factor works. Its only factors are 1 and 29, so 29 is **prime**. Number 1 has only one factor, so it is not prime.

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Divisibility, factors, multiples

By 2: last digit even. By 5: ends in 0 or 5. By 10: ends in 0. By 3 or 9: digit sum works.

Factors divide exactly; multiples are products.

Worked example: Is 126 divisible by 3? Add digits: $1 + 2 + 6 = 9$. Since 9 is divisible by 3, $126 \div 3 = 42$. So 3 is a factor and 126 is a multiple of 3.

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HCF and LCM

HCF is the largest common factor. LCM is the smallest common multiple.

Worked example: $12 = 2^2 \times 3$ and $18 = 2 \times 3^2$. HCF uses common smallest powers: $2 \times 3 = 6$. LCM uses largest powers: $2^2 \times 3^2 = 36$.

Use HCF for grouping; LCM for repeating events.

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Fractions and decimals

Use a common denominator to add fractions.

Worked example: $\frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{2}$. Change $\frac{1}{2}$ to $\frac{2}{4}$. Add: $\frac{1}{4} + \frac{2}{4} = \frac{3}{4}$. Decimal check: $0.25 + 0.50 = 0.75 = \frac{3}{4}$.

Practice: $0.25 = \frac{1}{4}$.

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Percentages: parts of a whole

Percent means per hundred. Formula: $\text{percentage} = \text{part} \div \text{whole} \times 100$.

Worked example: What percent is 20 of 80? Substitute: $20 \div 80 \times 100 = 0.25 \times 100 = 25\%$.

Check: $25\% \text{ of } 80 = 20$.

Practice: $15\% \text{ of } 200 = 30$.

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Profit, loss, and discount

Profit = selling price – cost price. Loss = cost price – selling price. Discount = marked price – selling price.

Worked example: CP ₹80, SP ₹100. Profit = ₹100 – ₹80 = ₹20. Profit% = profit ÷ CP × 100 = 20 ÷ 80 × 100 = **25%**.

Practice: ₹500 with 10% discount: discount = $10/100 \times 500 = ₹50$; selling price = **₹450**.

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Ratio

A ratio compares quantities in the same unit. Simplify like a fraction.

Worked example: 12:18. Divide both parts by their common factor 6: $12 \div 6 : 18 \div 6 = 2:3$. The order stays the same.

Practice: boys:girls = 15:10 = **3:2**.

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Proportion

In a proportion, two ratios are equal: $a:b = c:d$, so $ad = bc$.

Worked example: $3/5 = x/20$. Cross-multiply: $5x = 3 \times 20 = 60$. Divide by 5: $x = 12$. Common mistake: mixing units before comparing.

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Averages

Average = total $\div$ number of items. Total = average $\times$ number.

Worked example: Average of 6, 8, 10. Total = $6 + 8 + 10 = 24$. Number of items = 3. Average = $24 \div 3 = 8$.

Practice: average of 12 and 18 = **15**.

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Mixtures and alligation

A mixture combines items. Alligation compares cheaper and dearer values to get a mean value.

Worked example: Mix ₹20 rice and ₹40 rice to make ₹30 rice. Differences from mean: ₹30–₹20 = ₹10 and ₹40–₹30 = ₹10. Ratio of cheap:dear = 10:10 = **1:1**.

Draw a cross when values are unequal.

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Simple interest

$SI = P \times R \times T / 100$. Amount = $P + SI$.

Worked example: $P = ₹1,000$, $R = 5\%$, $T = 2$ years. $SI = 1,000 \times 5 \times 2 / 100 = ₹100$. Amount = $₹1,000 + ₹100 = ₹1,100$.

Keep rate and time in matching units.

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Compound interest

Interest is added to the amount each period. $\text{Amount} = P(1 + R/100)^T$.

Worked example: $P = ₹1,000$, $R = 10\%$, $T = 2$ years. $\text{Amount} = 1,000(1 + 10/100)^2 = 1,000 \times 1.1 \times 1.1 = ₹1,210$. $\text{CI} = ₹1,210 - ₹1,000 = ₹210$.

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Time and work

If a person finishes in 5 days, one-day work = $1/5$. Add daily rates when people work together.

Worked example: A takes 6 days, so rate = $1/6$. B takes 3 days, so rate = $1/3$. Together: $1/6 + 1/3 = 1/6 + 2/6 = 1/2$. Time = $1 \div 1/2 = 2$ days.

Use work units, not guesses.

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Pipes and cisterns

An inlet fills; an outlet empties. Treat each as a rate.

Worked example: Fill rate = $\frac{1}{4}$ tank per hour. Empty rate = $-\frac{1}{12}$. Net rate = $\frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{12} = \frac{3}{12} - \frac{1}{12} = \frac{1}{6}$. Time = $1 \div \frac{1}{6} = 6$ hours.

Use a minus sign for an outlet.

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Speed, distance, time

Speed = distance $\div$ time. Distance = speed $\times$ time. Time = distance $\div$ speed.

Worked example: Distance = 150 km, time = 3 h. Formula: speed = distance $\div$ time. Substitute:
 $150 \div 3 = 50$ km/h. Check: $50 \times 3 = 150$ km.

Convert minutes to hours before calculating.

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Trains

For a pole, distance is train length. For a platform, distance is train length + platform length.

Worked example: A 120 m train moves at 10 m/s across a pole. Formula: time = distance $\div$ speed
 $= 120 \div 10 = \mathbf{12 \text{ seconds}}$. For a platform, add both lengths first.

Practice: 200 m + 300 m at 25 m/s = **20 s**.

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Boats and streams

Downstream speed = boat speed + stream speed. Upstream = boat speed – stream speed.

Worked example: Boat speed in still water = 10 km/h; stream = 2 km/h. Downstream = $10 + 2 = 12$ km/h. Upstream = $10 - 2 = 8$ km/h.

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Permutations and combinations

Permutation means order matters: $nPr = n!/(n-r)!$. Combination means order does not matter: $nCr = n!/[r!(n-r)!]$.

Worked example: Choose 2 students from 4. Order does not matter, so use combination: $4C2 = 4 \times 3 / (2 \times 1) = 6$. If roles were captain and vice-captain, order would matter.

Ask: does changing order create a new result?

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Probability basics

Probability = favourable outcomes $\div$ total equally likely outcomes. It lies from 0 to 1.

Worked example: A fair die has 6 outcomes. Even outcomes are 2, 4, 6, so favourable = 3. $P(\text{even}) = 3 \div 6 = 1/2$.

Impossible = 0; certain = 1.

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Data interpretation: tables

Read the title, units, row labels, and totals before calculating. Compare only matching units.

Worked example: Sales are 20, 30, and 50. Total = $20 + 30 + 50 = 100$. Largest month is 50. If asked for its percentage: $50 \div 100 \times 100 = 50\%$.

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Data interpretation: charts

In a bar chart, compare heights. In a line chart, track change. In a pie chart, total angle is 360° .

Worked example: A pie slice is 90° . Share = $\text{angle} \div 360 \times 100 = 90 \div 360 \times 100 = 25\%$. Common mistake: reading a bar scale as 1 when it rises by 5.

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Number series

Check differences, ratios, alternating rules, squares, and primes.

Worked example: 2, 5, 8, 11, ?. Differences are +3 each time: $5 - 2 = 3$, $8 - 5 = 3$, $11 - 8 = 3$. Next = $11 + 3 = 14$.

Write differences below the terms.

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Letter series

Use alphabet positions A=1 to Z=26. Look for forward, backward, or alternating jumps.

Worked example: A, C, E, G, ?. Positions are 1, 3, 5, 7: each jump is +2. Next position is 9, so the answer is I.

Practice: Z, X, V, T, next = R.

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Analogy and classification

An analogy has the same relationship: Bird:fly :: fish:swim.

Worked example: Bird:fly :: fish:?. Clue: the first pair is animal:usual movement. Fish usually **swim**, so the answer is fish:swim.

Classification asks which item does not share the group. Example: apple, banana, carrot, mango → **carrot** is different because it is a vegetable.

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Coding and decoding

Compare each letter's change. Test a shift, reverse alphabet, position number, or word order.

Worked example: CAT → DBU. Clues: C→D, A→B, T→U. Each letter moves +1, so DOG becomes EPH: D→E, O→P, G→H. Answer: **EPH**.

Do not assume one rule without checking all letters.

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Blood relations

Draw a small family tree. Mark gender only when given. Start from “I” and move one relationship at a time.

Worked example: Question: “Ravi is the brother of Mina’s mother. How is Ravi related to Mina?”
Clues: Mina’s mother → her brother. Thinking: mother’s brother is an **uncle**. Answer: Ravi is Mina’s maternal uncle.

Common mistake: reversing “A is B’s sister.”

Bhavya Ponduri

Directions and distance

Draw north at the top. Move one step for each statement. Use a right triangle for final distance when needed.

Worked example: Walk 3 km east, then 4 km north. Clues make a right triangle. Distance = $\sqrt{3^2 + 4^2} = \sqrt{9 + 16} = \sqrt{25} = 5$ km. Final direction is north-east.

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Ranking and order

If a person is r th from the top and s th from the bottom, $\text{total} = r + s - 1$.

Worked example: A student is 7th from top and 9th from bottom. $\text{Total} = 7 + 9 - 1 = \mathbf{15}$ people.
Subtract 1 because the student was counted twice.

Check whether positions start at 1.

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Syllogisms

Use only the statements given. “All A are B” does not mean all B are A. Draw circles if helpful.

Worked example: Statements: All cats are animals. Some pets are cats. Thinking: those pets are cats, and every cat is an animal. Therefore some pets are **animals**. Do not use outside knowledge.

Bhavya Ponduri

Statement, conclusion, assumption

A conclusion must follow from the statement. An assumption is an unstated idea required for the statement to work.

Worked example: Statement: “The library extended hours so students can study after class.”
Conclusion: students have more study time after class — **yes, it follows**. Assumption: some students need or want to study after class.

Ask: must this be true, or could it be false? Separate facts from opinions.

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Seating arrangement

Draw fixed seats first. Mark left and right from the person's view. Place direct clues before indirect clues.

Worked example: Three seats are in a row. A is in the middle. B is left of A. Clues place B-A- C, so C is right of A. Answer: **A is between B and C.** For a circle, keep clockwise direction consistent.

Use a table to test cases.

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Floor and box puzzles

Make rows for floors or boxes. Fill exact positions first, then use “above,” “below,” “between,” and “not next to.”

Worked example: Floors 1, 2, 3: A is on floor 3; B is below A; C is below B. Fill from the fixed clue: A=3, B=2, C=1. Answer: **C is on floor 1**. Cross out impossible places.

Do not hold the whole puzzle in memory.

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Calendars and clocks

Calendar: odd days are days left after full weeks. Clock angle: minute hand moves 6° per minute; hour hand moves 0.5° per minute.

Worked example: At 3:00, the minute hand is at 12 and hour hand at 3. Angle = 3 quarter-turns? More simply, $3 \times 30^\circ = \mathbf{90^\circ}$. Use the reference time before calculating.

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Non-verbal reasoning

Look for rotation, reflection, addition or removal of parts, movement, and counting.

Worked example: A shape points up, then right, then down. Clue: it rotates 90° clockwise each step. Next it points **left**. Compare one feature at a time.

For mirror images, left and right swap but top and bottom stay.

Bhavya Ponduri

Fast method: R-P-S-C

Read the words. **Plan** the tool. **Solve** clearly. **Check** the answer.

Worked example: Question: 10% of 50. Read: wants 10%. Plan: percentage = $10/100 \times 50$. Solve: $0.1 \times 50 = 5$. Check: 5 is one tenth of 50. Answer: **5**.

When stuck, simplify the numbers, draw a diagram, or test small cases.

Bhavya Ponduri

Time management

Use three rounds: easy first, medium next, hard last. Set a time limit for one question.

Worked example: In a 30-minute set, spend 15 minutes on easy questions, 10 on medium questions, and 5 reviewing. If one question takes 4 minutes with no progress, mark it, skip it, and return later.

Accuracy first; speed grows with practice.

Bhavya Ponduri

Exam strategy

Read instructions, note negative marking, and keep rough work organised.

Worked example: If a question has options 20, 50, 80, and 500, and your estimate is about 60, eliminate 20 and 500 first. Recheck the formula before choosing 50 or 80.

Never change an answer without a reason. Sleep and arrive early.

Bhavya Ponduri

Mixed practice: arithmetic

1) 25% of 240. 2) HCF of 18 and 24. 3) Average of 7, 9, 14. 4) SI on ₹500 at 8% for 2 years.

Answers with brief steps: 1) $25/100 \times 240 = 60$. 2) Common factors include 1, 2, 3, 6, so HCF = 6. 3) $(7+9+14) \div 3 = 30 \div 3 = 10$. 4) $500 \times 8 \times 2 / 100 = ₹80$.

Show formulas before numbers.

Bhavya Ponduri

Mixed practice: aptitude

1) 3:5 ratio, total 64: smaller part? 2) 120 km in 3 h: speed? 3) 10% discount on ₹800? 4) $\frac{1}{4} + \frac{2}{3}$?

Answers with brief steps: 1) Parts=8, one part= $64 \div 8 = 8$, smaller= $3 \times 8 = 24$. 2) $120 \div 3 = 40$ km/h. 3) Discount= $10/100 \times 800 = ₹80$; price=₹720. 4) Common denominator 12: $3/12 + 8/12 = 11/12$.

Bhavya Ponduri

Mixed practice: reasoning

1) 3, 6, 12, 24, ?. 2) A is north of B; C east of A. Direction C from B? 3) 5th top and 8th bottom: total?

Answers with brief steps: 1) Each term $\times 2$: $24 \times 2 = 48$. 2) Draw north, then east: C is **north-east** of B. 3) $5 + 8 - 1 = 12$. The -1 removes the double count.

Draw, do not guess.

Bhavya Ponduri

Solved answer habits

Write the formula, substitute values, calculate, and label the answer.

Worked example: Question: distance 90 km in 3 h. Formula: speed = distance $\div$ time. Substitute: $90 \div 3 = 30$. Label: **30 km/h**. For reasoning, write the rule or draw the diagram; for data, quote the row, column, or scale.

These steps earn partial marks and reveal mistakes.

Bhavya Ponduri

Final revision checklist

- Order of operations and fractions.
- Percent, profit, ratio, average, interest.
- Work, speed, mixture, probability.
- Tables, charts, series, coding.
- Relations, directions, arrangements, syllogisms.
- R-P-S-C method and time plan.

Worked example: Before a test, revise one weak topic: for 25% of 80, use $25/100 \times 80 = 20$. Then write the mistake you would avoid: forgetting $\div 100$.

Revise mistakes, not just correct answers.

Bhavya Ponduri

Mini mock test

- 1) 40% of 150. 2) LCM of 8 and 12. 3) A 180 m train at 15 m/s crosses a pole. 4) Next: 4, 9, 14, 19.
5) All roses are flowers; some flowers fade. Must some roses fade?

Try without notes. Worked sample: For Q3, $\text{time} = \text{distance} \div \text{speed} = 180 \div 15 = 12 \text{ seconds}$.
Suggested time: 8 minutes.

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Mini mock: answer key

1) 60. 2) 24. 3) 12 seconds. 4) 24. 5) No; the statement does not say roses are among the flowers that fade.

Brief explanations: 1) $40/100 \times 150 = 60$. 2) Multiples meet first at 24. 3) $180 \div 15 = 12$. 4) Add 5: $19 + 5 = 24$. 5) “Some flowers” may be flowers other than roses.

Review the method for every wrong answer.

Bhavya Ponduri

Keep learning

Practise a few questions daily. Keep a mistake notebook with: question type, wrong step, correct idea, and a similar example.

Worked example: If you missed $1/4 + 1/2$, write the correct idea: use a common denominator. Then solve $1/4 + 2/4 = 3/4$. Try a similar question the next day.

Easy English, clear steps, and repeated practice turn unfamiliar questions into familiar patterns.

Final reminder: Read → Plan → Solve → Check.

Bhavya Ponduri

Workbook 1 · Arithmetic foundations

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: quantities, operations, number systems.
2. Rules: brackets, factors, multiples, HCF and LCM.
3. Worked 1: $48 + 12 \times 3 = 84$.
4. Worked 2: $\text{HCF}(18,24)=6$; $\text{LCM}(6,8)=24$.
5. Application: class scores and shopping totals.
6. Mistakes: wrong order or mixed units.
7. Practice: 25% of 160; round $497+302$.
8. Answers: 40; about 800 (exact 799). Explain each step.

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Workbook 2 · Ratio, proportion and averages

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: compare quantities and share fairly.
2. Rules: $\text{average} = \text{total} \div \text{count}$; ratio parts add.
3. Worked 1: ₹500 in 2:3 gives ₹200 and ₹300.
4. Worked 2: average of 8,10,12 is 10.
5. Application: teams, recipes, salaries.
6. Mistakes: unweighted averages and unlike units.
7. Practice: share 360 in 4:5; average 14,18,22.
8. Answers: 160/200; 18, with the division shown.

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Workbook 3 · Mixtures and interest

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: combine quantities and grow money.
2. Rules: $SI = P \times R \times T \div 100$; compound interest adds to principal.
3. Worked 1: SI on ₹1,000 at 5% for 2 years = ₹100.
4. Worked 2: 2 L water + 3 L juice gives 2:3.
5. Application: savings and simple business costs.
6. Mistakes: forgetting time or weighting quantities.
7. Practice: SI on ₹2,000 at 6% for 1 year.
8. Answer: ₹120; write P, R, and T before solving.

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Workbook 4 · Time, work and pipes

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: work is completed through rates.
2. Rule: one-day work = $1 \div \text{days}$; add filling rates, subtract drains.
3. Worked 1: a 6-day job has rate $1/6$ per day.
4. Worked 2: two equal workers complete twice the daily work.
5. Application: work schedules and tanks.
6. Mistakes: adding times instead of rates.
7. Practice: compare 4-day and 6-day workers.
8. Answer: rate is $1/4 + 1/6 = 5/12$ per day; show the common denominator.

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Workbook 5 · Speed, trains and boats

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: distance, speed, and time.
2. Rules: $d=st$; downstream adds stream speed.
3. Worked 1: 180 km in 3 h = 60 km/h.
4. Worked 2: 120 m at 12 m/s takes 10 s.
5. Application: travel routes and maps.
6. Mistakes: mixing minutes and hours.
7. Practice: 50 km/h for 3 h; boat 8 with stream 2 upstream.
8. Answers: 150 km; 6 km/h. Check units and direction.

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Workbook 6 · Counting, probability and data

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: count choices and read evidence.
2. Rules: $\text{probability} = \text{favourable} \div \text{total}$; multiply independent choices.
3. Worked 1: $P(\text{heads}) = 1/2$.
4. Worked 2: $3 \text{ shirts} \times 2 \text{ trousers} = 6 \text{ outfits}$.
5. Application: tables and charts for orders and scores.
6. Mistakes: missing scale or comparing unlike rows.
7. Practice: die shows 4; totals 16, 24, 20.
8. Answers: $1/6$; 60. Read labels before arithmetic.

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Workbook 7 · Series, analogy and coding

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: find the smallest repeating rule.
2. Rules: test differences, ratios, alternation, A=1 to Z=26.
3. Worked 1: 2,4,8,16 $\rightarrow$ 32.
4. Worked 2: CAT $\rightarrow$ DBU by shifting +1; DOG $\rightarrow$ EPH.
5. Application: classification and word codes.
6. Mistakes: choosing a rule that fits only two terms.
7. Practice: 5,10,15,__ and BAD +1.
8. Answers: 20 and CBE. Verify every term.

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Workbook 8 · Relations, directions and ranking

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: turn words into arrows, trees, and lines.
2. Rules: from right = total – from left + 1.
3. Worked 1: 7th of 20 from left is 14th from right.
4. Worked 2: 3 km east then 4 km north gives 5 km displacement.
5. Application: maps, queues, and family trees.
6. Mistakes: changing viewpoint or skipping a link.
7. Practice: 15 people, 4th from left; mother's sister.
8. Answers: 12th; aunt. Sketch before answering.

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Workbook 9 · Logic, puzzles and calendars

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: prove what must follow from given facts.
2. Rules: all $A \rightarrow B$ is not all $B \rightarrow A$; days repeat every 7.
3. Worked 1: all managers trained; Ravi manager $\rightarrow$ trained.
4. Worked 2: Tuesday + 10 days = Friday.
5. Application: seating, floors, boxes, clocks, non-verbal patterns.
6. Mistakes: outside knowledge and mental juggling.
7. Practice: no buses are bicycles; angle at 3:00.
8. Answers: bus is not bicycle; 90° . Use diagrams and tables.

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Workbook 10 · Method, mocks and revision

8-page learning sequence

1. Concept: Read, Plan, Solve, Check (R-P-S-C).
2. Rules: easy first, mark hard items, protect checking time.
3. Worked 1: 20% off ₹500 → ₹400.
4. Worked 2: error log: topic, mistake, rule, next action.
5. Application: mixed arithmetic, aptitude, reasoning mocks.
6. Mistakes: rushing, wrong units, copied numbers.
7. Practice: timed set plus final revision checklist.
8. Answer key: review method and explanation, not only score; keep learning in small regular sessions.

Bhavya Ponduri